- Conversion of inactive form of folic acid into its active form
- Reducing agent to keep iron in its ferrous form to facilitate iron solubility.
- Adrenal cortex function.
- Enhances calcium absorption.

- **Food Sources:** Citrus fruits like orange, lemon, tomatoes, guava, watermelon are good sources of Vitamin C



- **Deficiency:** Scurvy the most severe form of vitamin C deficiency arises mainly due to faulty cooking habits and inadequate intake of fruits and vegetables. The clinical features of scurvy are characterized by gingivitis (bleeding gums) petechiae (small hemorrhagic spots), arthralgia (pain in the joint), depression, postural hypotension, delayed wound healing. Main deficiency symptoms in infants include tender bones, cessation of bone growth, anaemia and pyrexia.


Scurvy


Scurvy leg


Scurvy

5.4 WATER

Water: Water is defined as an essential nutrient because it is required in amounts that exceed the body's ability to produce it. All biochemical reactions occur in water. It fills the spaces in and between cells and

Chapter5_088-119.indd 24 18-01-2019 12:29:19